

THE GROUNDWORK METHOD • BY JUNO COLLECTIVE

The operating model



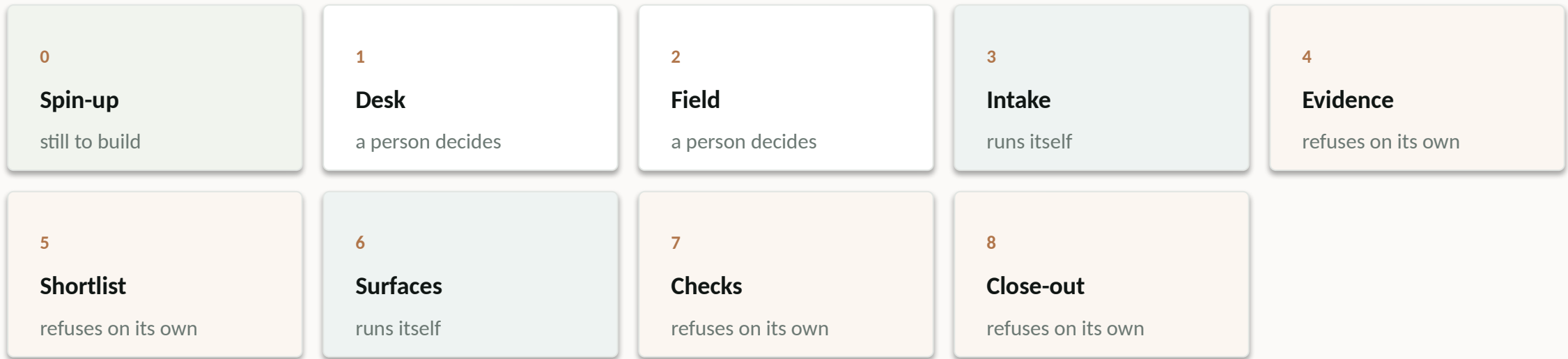
How a market runs, and what has to be true before a second team can run one.



Who runs the second market, and what do they run it on?

A market runs as a sequence of stages, and each one has to produce its own evidence before the next can start. That sequence is written down, most of it is automated, and the parts that are not are the parts where a person should be deciding.

Nine stages across four moves, each one gated



Three stages run without supervision, three refuse on their own terms, two are judgment, and one is still to build. The shape is the point: the places a person is needed are few, and they are the same in every market.

Four stages refuse on their own terms



Evidence

Every recording's claims reach the register, and the statement that they do is a number rather than an impression.



Shortlist

Every quotation that reaches a client surface resolves back to a recording and a timecode in one step.



Checks

Plant one fault of each kind in a fresh engagement and watch every check refuse it.



Close-out

A market cannot be closed while its learnings are missing or unclassified.

Each of these is a test the work has to pass, not a note somebody is asked to remember.

Four roles, and only one is hard

Market lead

The rooms, the reading, and the judgment about what a town is actually saying.

Recruited and certified

Evidence operator

The intake pipeline, the routine adjudications, and the escalations.

Recruited and trained on the checks

Standards

The checks, the close-out, the contested rows, and the instruments themselves.

The role to design down, not to duplicate

Client and commercial

The relationship, the scope, the room.

Already in place

Three of these are recruited. The fourth is the one to be careful about, and the answer is not another person like it. Every judgment that currently sits in the standards role is a piece of work: move it into a check, and it stops needing to be a role at all in the market after that.

Five things have to be true

1 The checks install as one thing

scoped

2 The close-out refuses without its learnings

in place

3 A market instantiates

part-built

4 The working practice is written down

scoped

5 The evidence layer holds more than three markets

part-built

In dependency order. None of these is a research problem; all of them are build work, and the first one comes first because until a new team's output is refused by the same rules, every later step adds risk faster than it adds capacity.

The market cannot close until it is written down

Every market has one route the money legally travels, and that route decides which claims are available.

In one market, property tax reaches the school district, the county and the sheriff, and not the town's own revenue base. That the schools were transformed survives scrutiny. That the town was transformed does not.

A figure heard in the field is one person's testimony on the day it is heard, however credible the speaker and however often it is repeated back.

One market produced a set of vivid, widely repeated numbers about a school district and a county tax base. Every one of them was a single source. Fourteen went into verification.

The close-out refuses to complete while a market's learnings are missing or unclassified. That is what stops the second market from paying to learn what the first one already knew.



The next step is a conversation about which of these to build first.

Everything above is either running, part-built, or scoped. What is not decided is the order, and that is worth deciding together rather than separately.